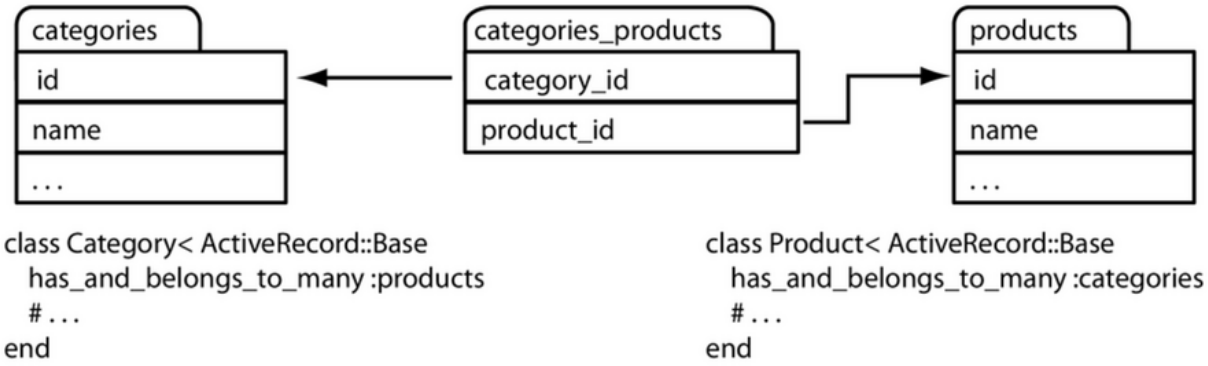


In Rails we can express this by adding the `has_and_belongs_to_many` declaration to both models.

Many-to-many associations are symmetrical—both of the joined tables declare their association with each other using “habtm.”

Rails implements many-to-many associations using an intermediate join table. This contains foreign key pairs linking the two target tables. Active Record assumes that this join table’s name is the concatenation of the two target table names in alphabetical order. In our example, we joined the table `categories` to the table `products`, so Active Record will look for a join table named `categories_products`.

We can also define join tables directly. In the Depot application, we defined a `LineItems` join, which joined `Products` to either `Carts` or `Orders`. Defining it ourselves also gave us a place to store an additional attribute, namely, a `quantity`.

Now that we’ve covered data definitions, the next thing you would naturally want to do is access the data contained within the database, so let’s do that.